

CANADIAN EMTs by Patrick Kohn (performed at The PIT 2025)

INT. GROCERY STORE - DAY

A MAN is laying unconscious on the ground in the middle of a Stop & Shop produce section. Two CANADIANS wearing paramedic uniforms are standing over that unconscious MAN next to his SPOUSE. SHOPPERS and EMPLOYEES crowd around to see what's going on and in case they can be of assistance.

CANADIAN 1

(to spouse)

So you were saying that he just collapsed out of nowhere, eh. Is that right?

SPOUSE

(nervously)

Exactly! Right there, without a word! Please help him!

CANADIAN 2

Well thanks for calling us to come help, eh. We're happy to do whatever we can to sustain his life.

CANADIAN 1

Right on the nose, eh. Now if you'll excuse me I'm worried your husband may have suffered a heart oopsie so I'm going to check his pulse and see if he's breathing.

CANADIAN 2

If it's not too big a problem, I'd ask you to back up just a bit so we can get in close, eh.

Spouse takes a step back, while Canadian 1 and 2 both step towards the still unconscious MAN. Canadian 1 bumps into the spouse.

CANADIAN 1

Ope, sorry, eh.

Canadian 1 then steps back but in doing so, Canadian 2 bumps into them.

CANADIAN 2

Ope, sorry.

CANADIAN 1
Sorry. Sorry.

CANADIAN 2
Sorry, eh.

SPOUSE
Stop apologizing and just help my
husband already!!

CANADIANS 1 AND 2
Sorry.

Canadian 1 kneels down next to the unconscious man facing
him.

CANADIAN 1
(to the MAN)
Hey, I'm sorry to see you're
unconscious, eh. If it's not too
much a bother I'm just gonna check
your pulse and breathing to help us
decide if we need to perform CPR,
eh.

Canadian 1 waits a beat, gets no response from the man.

CANADIAN 1 (CONT'D)
I'm sorry but since I you didn't
provide consent I'm hesitant to
touch you because I don't want to
violate a preexisting boundary, eh.

SPOUSE
Help him already! I'm his spouse,
and I'm providing consent.

CANADIAN 1
Sorry. Thank you.

CANADIAN 2
Sorry, eh.

Canadian 1 puts his head above the man's mouth and fingers on
his neck to feel his pulse.

CANADIAN 1
Yeah, I'm sorry to say but he's got
no pulse or breath sounds so we're
going to have to start CPR, eh.

CANADIAN 2
Heart really biffed it, eh?

CANADIAN 1

Whole cardiopulmonary system took a nap on the chesterfield, eh.

CANADIAN 2

Sounds like his blood pump went on lunch to grab a double double and Timbits, eh.

CANADIAN 1

I'd have thought so with the skookum Molson muscle on this one, eh.

CANADIAN 2

Oh yeah, real beaut. I'd give a toonie to fill a bunnyhug like that, eh.

CANADIAN 1

Couldn't've said it better myself, eh.

SPOUSE

Oh my god! Just stop talking already and save him!

Canadian 2 kneels down above the man's head with a hand squeezed ventilator. Canadian 1 starts performing chest compressions. Both apologize after each compression/ventilation.

CANADIAN 1

(to the MAN)

Sorry.

CANADIAN 2

(to the MAN)

Sorry.

CANADIAN 1

Sorry. Sorry

CANADIAN 2

Sorry.

CANADIAN 1

Sorry.

Canadian 1 bunks Canadian 2 with their elbow. He stops the chest compressions.

CANADIAN 1 (CONT'D)
 (to CANADIAN 2)
 Sorry.

Canadian 2 stops ventilating.

CANADIAN 2
 (to CANADIAN 1)
 Sorry, eh.

CANADIAN 1
 No I'm sorry, eh.

CANADIAN 2
 Sorry. Sorry.

ALL THE SHOPPERS, EMPLOYEES, AND SPOUSE
 Shut up!

CANADIANS 1 AND 2
 Sorry.

The previously unconscious man wakes up and gasps, then looks angrily at the Canadians.

MAN
 Shut up!!!

CANADIANS 1 AND 2
 Sorry.

MAN
 I wish you let me die so I didn't
 have to hear this!

CANADIANS 1 AND 2
 Sorry!

The man stabs himself in the heart, screams, then goes limp and assumedly dies.

SPOUSE
 Noooo!!!

CANADIANS 1 AND 2
 Sorry!!!

FADE TO BLACK.